Scribble to Digital

Project Description

Converting handwritten notes into digital format is a common challenge faced by students and professionals. Poor lighting, unclear handwriting, and mixed content (notes + tasks) reduce productivity and require manual rewriting.

Scribble to Digital is an AI-powered system that converts messy handwritten notes into clean, structured digital text. The system enhances uploaded images, extracts text using OCR, and applies Generative AI to correct grammar and automatically extract To-Do tasks.

The application is developed using Streamlit as the frontend framework and Python as the backend processing engine.

Use Case Scenarios

Scenario 1: Handwritten Note Digitization with Image Enhancement

Users upload a photo of messy handwritten notes through the Streamlit interface. The system internally enhances the image using OpenCV by converting it to grayscale, increasing brightness and contrast, reducing noise, and applying thresholding techniques.

After enhancement, the improved image is passed to the OCR engine for accurate text extraction. This process ensures better readability and higher text recognition accuracy even for low-quality or unclear handwriting.

The output includes:

- Raw OCR extracted text
- Improved clarity for further AI processing

Scenario 2: Intelligent Text Correction and Contextual Reconstruction

After OCR extraction, the raw text may contain spelling mistakes, missing letters, and broken words due to handwriting variations.

The Generative AI model analyzes the extracted text and:

- Corrects spelling errors
- Improves grammar and sentence structure

- Reconstructs incomplete or unclear words using contextual understanding
- Formats the text into readable paragraphs

This ensures that messy handwritten content is converted into professional and well-structured digital text.

Scenario 3: Automatic To-Do Extraction and Task Identification

Handwritten notes often contain a mixture of general information and actionable tasks. Identifying tasks manually can be time-consuming.

The AI system analyses sentence intent and:

- Detects task-oriented statements
- Extracts actionable items
- Organizes them into a structured bullet-point To-Do list

This allows users to quickly identify important tasks separately from general notes, improving productivity and task management.

Architecture Overview

Scribble to Digital is an intelligent AI-powered web application designed to convert handwritten notes into clean, structured digital text. The platform is built using the Streamlit framework, enabling rapid development of an interactive user interface.

The system integrates:

- Streamlit for frontend and application logic
- OpenCV for image preprocessing and enhancement
- OCR Engine (Tesseract/EasyOCR) for text extraction
- Google Gemini 2.5 Flash (Generative AI) for contextual correction, formatting, and task extraction

The platform processes handwritten images, enhances clarity, extracts text, corrects errors using AI, and optionally generates structured outputs such as formatted notes and to-do lists.

Core Technologies

- Streamlit: Interactive web application framework for UI, file uploads, and result display
- Google Gemini 2.5 Flash: AI model for contextual understanding, grammar correction, and smart task extraction
- OpenCV: Image preprocessing (grayscale conversion, noise removal, thresholding)
- OCR (Tesseract/EasyOCR): Converts enhanced handwritten images into raw digital text
- Python: Core programming language
- ReportLab / Python-DOCX: Optional export to PDF and Word formats

Component-Wise Architecture

Component	Description

Streamlit Frontend UI	Provides a simple web interface for users to upload handwritten images. Displays enhanced images, extracted text, corrected content, and to-do lists dynamically.
Image Processing Layer (OpenCV)	Enhances uploaded images by converting to grayscale, adjusting brightness/contrast, reducing noise, and applying thresholding to improve OCR accuracy.
OCR Layer	Extracts raw text from the processed image. Handles handwriting recognition and converts image content into machine-readable text.
Generative AI Layer (Gemini 2.5 Flash)	Processes extracted text to: • Correct spelling and grammar • Reconstruct incomplete words • Format into structured paragraphs • Extract actionable to-do items
Export Module	Converts AI-processed content into downloadable formats such as PDF or Word documents.

Pre-requisites

1. Google AI Studio Account Setup – To generate Gemini API Key
2. Python 3.8+ Installed
3. Streamlit Framework Installed
4.
```
pip install streamlit
```
5. Required Python Libraries
    - opencv-python
    - pytesseract / easyocr
    - google-generativeai
    - pillow
    - reportlab (for PDF export)
    - python-docx (for Word export)
6. Tesseract OCR Installed (if using pytesseract)

Project Workflow

1. Gemini AI Setup & Initialization

Activity 1.1: Set up Google AI Studio with Gemini API

- Create or sign in to Google AI Studio account
- Generate API key for Gemini model access
- Enable Gemini 2.5 Flash model
- Test API integration using a sample prompt

Activity 1.2: Configure API Keys and Environment

- Store GEMINI_API_KEY securely in .env file
- Load environment variables using python-dotenv
- Configure model parameters:
  - Temperature
  - Max output tokens
  - Response format
- Validate API connectivity inside Streamlit app

Activity 1.3: Design AI Prompts for Note Processing

- Create prompt template for:
  - Grammar correction
  - Sentence reconstruction
  - Formatting messy text into structured paragraphs
- Design separate prompt for:
  - To-do task extraction
  - Task prioritization (if needed)
- Test prompt effectiveness with sample handwritten text

2. Core Functionality Development

Activity 2.1: Design Streamlit App Structure

- Create modular project structure:

```
scribble_to_digital/
    app.py
    utils/
        image_processing.py
        ocr_engine.py
        ai_processor.py
    outputs/
```

Configure Streamlit layout:

- Title & description
- File uploader
- Processing buttons
- Output display sections

Activity 2.2: Implement Image Processing Module

- Accept image upload (JPG/PNG)
- Apply preprocessing using OpenCV:
  - Convert to grayscale
  - Adjust brightness & contrast

    - Remove noise
    - Apply thresholding
- Display enhanced image preview in Streamlit

Activity 2.3: Implement OCR Extraction
- Integrate Tesseract or EasyOCR
- Extract raw handwritten text
- Clean unnecessary symbols
- Display raw OCR output for comparison

Activity 2.4: AI-Based Contextual Processing
- Send OCR text to Gemini API
- Perform:
    - Grammar correction
    - Sentence completion
    - Context-based word guessing
    - Formatting into structured notes
- Extract action items separately
- Return:
    - Clean digital text
    - Structured to-do list

3. Streamlit UI Implementation

Activity 3.1: Build Interactive UI Components
- st.file_uploader() for image upload
- st.image() for displaying uploaded & enhanced image
- st.button() for processing steps
- st.spinner() for loading indication
- st.text_area() for displaying extracted text

Activity 3.2: Display Structured Results
- Section 1: Enhanced Image
- Section 2: Raw OCR Text
- Section 3: AI-Corrected Digital Notes
- Section 4: Extracted To-Do Tasks (bullet format)

Optional:
- Checkbox to show/hide raw OCR
- Download buttons for final output

Activity 3.3: Add Export Functionality

- Generate downloadable:
  - PDF (using ReportLab)
  - Word file (using python-docx)
- Use st.download_button()
- Allow preview before download

4. Testing & Optimization

Activity 4.1: Functional Testing

- Test with:
  - Clear handwriting
  - Messy handwriting
  - Mixed text + tasks
  - Bullet points
- Validate OCR accuracy
- Validate AI corrections

Activity 4.2: Evaluate AI Response Quality

- Check:
  - Grammar correction accuracy
  - Logical sentence flow
  - Proper formatting
  - Correct task extraction
- Ensure no hallucinated content

Activity 4.3: Performance Optimization

- Optimize image preprocessing steps
- Reduce API token usage
- Add error handling for:
  - Empty image
  - API failure
  - OCR failure
- Improve prompt clarity

Activity 4.4: Ensure Export Quality

- Validate PDF formatting
- Check Word document structure
- Ensure file compatibility

- Test downloads across browsers

MILESTONE 1: Generative AI Initialization

Project: Scribble to Digital (Streamlit Framework)

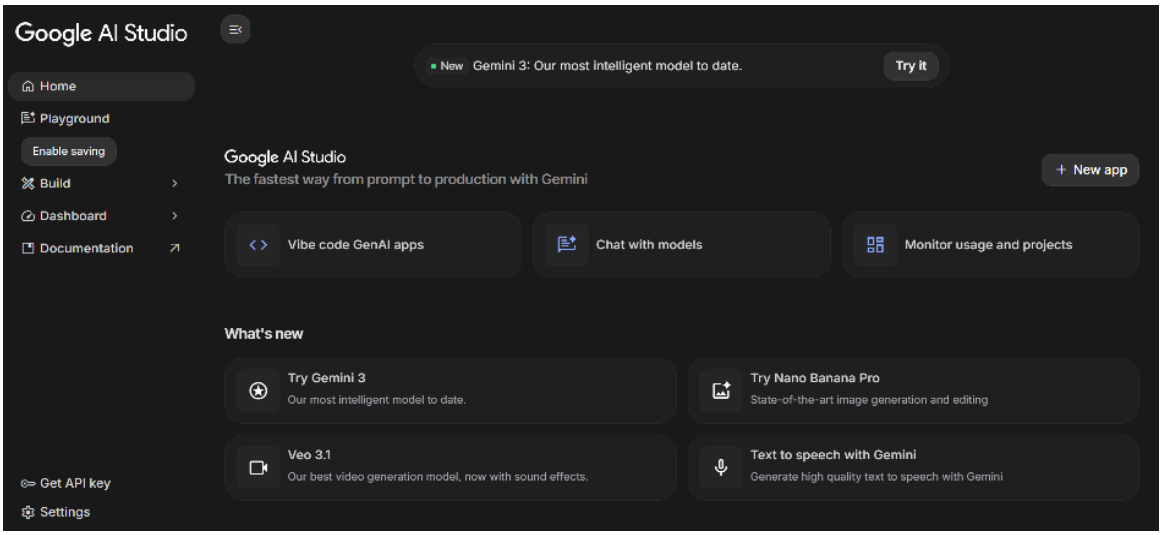
In this foundational stage, the objective is to establish and configure the AI infrastructure required to power the Scribble to Digital application.

The platform uses Gemini 2.5 Flash, Google's fast and efficient multimodal model, to:

- Correct messy handwritten OCR text
- Improve grammar and sentence flow
- Reconstruct incomplete words
- Extract structured to-do tasks
- Convert handwritten notes into clean digital format

Activity 1.1: Set up Google AI Studio and Enable Gemini API

1. Sign in to Google AI Studio



1. Visit: https://makersuite.google.com/app/apikey
2. Sign in with your Google account
3. Accept terms and conditions

2. Create API Key

- Click "Create API Key"
- Copy the generated API key
- Store it securely in a .env file

3. Select Model

Choose: Gemini 2.5 Flash

Model Features:

- Fast response time
- Efficient token usage
- Suitable for text correction & formatting
- Free tier supports multiple requests per minute

Best for:

- OCR text cleaning
- Contextual rewriting
- Structured note generation

Activity 1.2: Configure Environment and Test Connection (Streamlit Setup)

Step 1: Create. env File
Inside your project folder:

```
scribble_to_digital/
    app.py
    .env
```

Add:

```
GEMINI_API_KEY=your_api_key_here
```

Step 2: Install Required Dependencies

```
pip install streamlit google-generativeai python-dotenv pillow opencv-python pytesseract
```

Libraries Used:

- streamlit UI framework
- google-generativeai Gemini API integration
- python-dotenv Load environment variables
- opencv-python Image preprocessing
- pytesseract OCR text extraction
- pillow Image handling

Step 3: Test Gemini API Connection in Streamlit

Create a simple test inside app.py:

```
import streamlit as st
import google.generativeai as genai
import os
from dotenv import load_dotenv

# Load API key
load_dotenv()
genai.configure(api_key=os.getenv("GEMINI_API_KEY"))

# Select model
model = genai.GenerativeModel("models/gemini-2.5-flash")

st.title("Gemini API Test - Scribble to Digital")

if st.button("Test AI Connection"):
    response = model.generate_content(
        "Correct this sentence: i am go school tomorrow"
    )
    st.write("AI Response:")
    st.write(response.text)
```

Activity 1.3: Validate Connectivity and Response Quality

Test Case 1: Grammar Correction

Input:

```
i am go school tomorrow
```

Expected Output:

```
I am going to school tomorrow.
```

Test Case 2: Structured Note Formatting

Input:

```
math exam monday
study algebra
buy pen
```

Expected Output:

- Formatted paragraph
- Bullet list tasks extracted

MILESTONE 2: Core Functionalities Development (Streamlit)

This milestone focuses on building the complete working application using Streamlit + Gemini 2.5 Flash.

The goal is to:

- Upload handwritten note images
- Extract text using OCR
- Clean & correct text using Gemini
- Extract tasks automatically
- Display structured digital output
- Enable download options

File Explorer Structure

```
scribble_to_digital/
│
├── app.py                  # Main Streamlit application
├── .env                    # API key storage
├── requirements.txt        # Python dependencies
│
├── utils/
│   ├── ocr_processor.py    # Image preprocessing & OCR
│   ├── ai_processor.py     # Gemini integration
│   └── file_export.py      # Export functions (PDF / TXT)
│
├── assets/
│   └── sample_images/
│
└── outputs/                # Generated files
```

Activity 2.1: Streamlit Initialization and Import Libraries
Import Required Libraries
In app.py:

```python
import streamlit as st
import google.generativeai as genai
import os
from dotenv import load_dotenv
from PIL import Image
import pytesseract
import cv2
import numpy as np
```

Configure Gemini Model

```python
load_dotenv()
genai.configure(api_key=os.getenv("GEMINI_API_KEY"))

model = genai.GenerativeModel("models/gemini-2.5-flash")
```

Activity 2.2: OCR Processing Module

Create utils/ocr_processor.py

```python
import cv2
import pytesseract
import numpy as np

def extract_text_from_image(uploaded_image):
    image = np.array(uploaded_image)
    gray = cv2.cvtColor(image, cv2.COLOR_BGR2GRAY)
    gray = cv2.threshold(gray, 150, 255, cv2.THRESH_BINARY)[1]

    text = pytesseract.image_to_string(gray)
    return text
```

Purpose:

- Convert image to grayscale
- Improve brightness
- Remove noise

- Extract raw OCR text

Activity 2.3: Gemini AI Processing Module

Create utils/ai_processor.py

```
import google.generativeai as genai

model = genai.GenerativeModel("models/gemini-2.5-flash")

def clean_and_structure_text(raw_text):
    prompt = f"""
    You are an AI note cleaner.
    1. Correct spelling and grammar.
    2. Reconstruct incomplete words.
    3. Format text properly.
    4. Extract action items as bullet points.

    Raw Text:
    {raw_text}
    """

    response = model.generate_content(prompt)
    return response.text
```

AI Responsibilities:

- Grammar correction
- Sentence restructuring
- Context guessing
- To-Do extraction

Activity 2.4: Streamlit Main UI Logic

Inside app.py

```
st.title("✍️ Scribble to Digital")

uploaded_file = st.file_uploader(
    "Upload Handwritten Notes Image",
    type=["jpg", "png", "jpeg"]
)

if uploaded_file is not None:
    image = Image.open(uploaded_file)
    st.image(image, caption="Uploaded Image", use_column_width=True)

    if st.button("Convert to Digital"):

        raw_text = extract_text_from_image(image)

        st.subheader("📜 Extracted Raw Text")
        st.text_area("OCR Output", raw_text, height=150)

        clean_text = clean_and_structure_text(raw_text)

        st.subheader("✨ Cleaned & Structured Output")
        st.write(clean_text)
```

Activity 2.5: Export Functionality
Create utils/file_export.py
Save as TXT

```
def save_as_txt(content, filename):
    with open(f"outputs/{filename}.txt", "w", encoding="utf-8") as f:
        f.write(content)
```

In app.py:

```
if st.button("Download as TXT"):
    save_as_txt(clean_text, "digital_notes")
    st.success("File saved in outputs folder.")
```

MILESTONE 3: Backend – Flask Integration (app.py)

This milestone focuses on implementing the complete Flask backend for the Scribble to Digital application, including OCR processing, GenAI integration, task extraction, error handling, and export functionality.

Activity 3.1: Complete Route Definitions

All routes are properly defined with:

1. Input Validation

- Validates uploaded image file type (.jpg, .png, .jpeg)
- Checks for empty file upload
- Validates file size limit
- Ensures image can be processed

2. Error Handling

1. Handles OCR processing errors
2. Handles Gemini API failures
3. Returns proper JSON error responses
4. Prevents server crash on invalid input

3. Logging

- Logs image upload events
- Logs OCR extracted text
- Logs GenAI responses
- Logs export operations
- Debug logs for development mode

4. Response Formatting

- Structured JSON response:

```
{
  "status": "success",
  "clean_text": "...",
  "todo_list": [...]
}
```

Activity 3.2: Modular Architecture

Main Application Structure

```
scribble_to_digital/
│
├── app.py                # Main Flask server
├── routes/
│   └── process.py        # OCR + AI logic routes
├── services/
│   ├── ocr_service.py    # Image enhancement + OCR
│   ├── ai_service.py     # Gemini processing
│   └── export_service.py # PDF/Word export
├── utils/
│   └── validators.py     # File validation
└── uploads/
```

Separation of Concerns

- ocr_service.py Handles image preprocessing & Tesseract
- ai_service.py Handles contextual correction & to-do extraction
- export_service.py Handles file generation
- app.py Controls routes & server startup

Flask Server Initialization (app.py)

```python
if __name__ == "__main__":
    print("="*60)
    print("✍️ Scribble to Digital - Starting Server")
    print("="*60)
    print("✓ OCR Engine Initialized")
    print("✓ Gemini API Key Configured")
    print("✓ To-Do Extraction Enabled")
    print("\nServer running at: http://localhost:5000")
    print("="*60)

    app.run(debug=True, host="0.0.0.0", port=5000)
```

Activity 3.3: Export Implementation

Complete implementation of:

1. PDF Generation

- Clean formatted digital notes
- Structured to-do list section
- Professional layout
- Downloadable file

2. Word Document Export (.docx)

- Heading styles
- Bullet points for tasks
- Editable format

3. CSV Export (Task List)

- Task column
- Status column (Pending/Done)
- Compatible with Excel

4. File Cleanup & Management

- Temporary file storage
- Auto-delete after download
- Secure file handling

MILESTONE 4: UI Development

This milestone focuses on building a modern, responsive, and interactive frontend interface using Streamlit for the Scribble to Digital application.

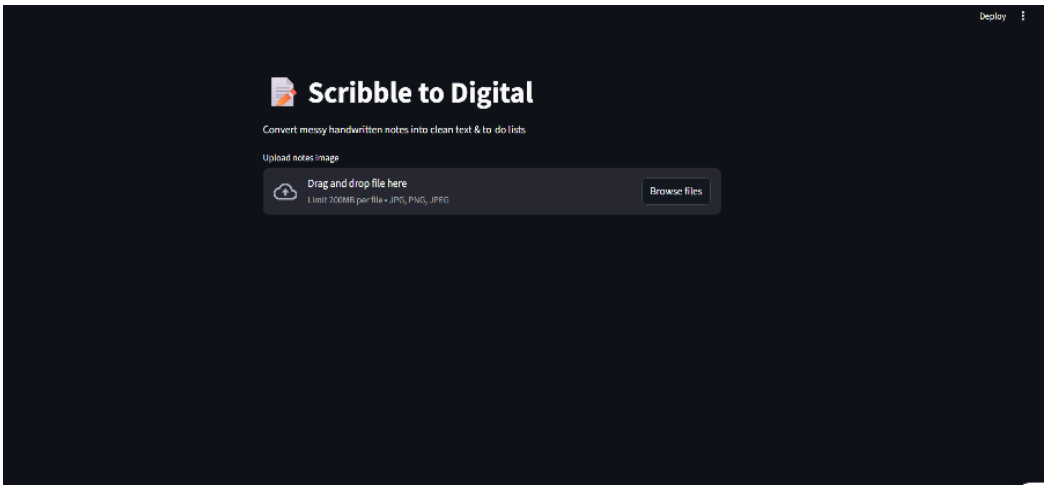
The UI allows users to:

- Upload handwritten notes

- Process them using OCR + Generative AI
- View structured digital output
- Download formatted results

Activity 4.1: Landing Page Development

Home Page: Transform Your Notes into Digital Intelligence



Hero Section

Title:

Transform Your Handwritten Notes into Smart Digital Content

Subtitle:

Convert messy notes into clean text and structured to-do lists using OCR and AI.

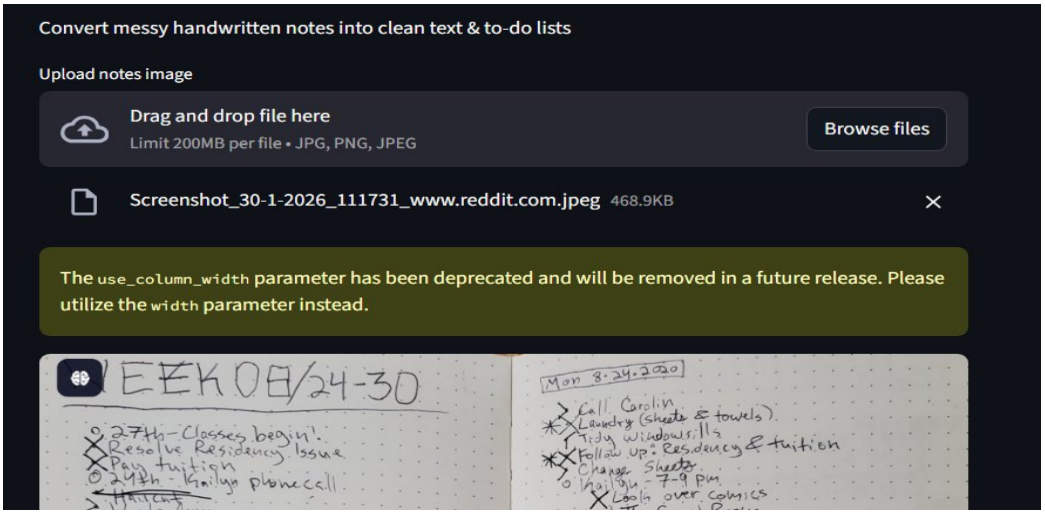
Feature Cards Section

Using Streamlit columns layout:

```
[ Upload Notes ]     [ Smart Correction ]     [ To-Do Extraction ]
```

1. Upload Notes

- Accept handwritten image
- Supports JPG, PNG, JPEG
- Instant preview



2. Smart Correction

- Fixes spelling mistakes
- Uses contextual AI logic
- Improves readability

3. To-Do Extraction

- Identifies action items
- Converts tasks into list format
- Separates notes from tasks

Activity 4.2: Processing Page (Main Generator Page)

Handwritten Notes Processing Page

Input Fields:

- Image Upload Section
- Convert Button
- Reset Button

UI Layout (Streamlit Flow)

```
-----------------------------------+---------
| ✍️ Scribble to Digital                     |
-----------------------------------------------
| Upload Handwritten Notes                   |
| [ Choose File ]                            |
-----------------------------------------------
| Image Preview                              |
-----------------------------------------------
| [ Convert to Digital ✨ ]                  |
-----------------------------------------------
| 📄 Clean Digital Text                      |
| [ Scrollable Text Area ]                   |
-----------------------------------------------
| ✅ Extracted To-Do List                    |
| [ Scrollable Text Area ]                   |
-----------------------------------------------
| [ Download as TXT ]  [ Download CSV ]      |
```

Activity 4.3: UI Components Implementation (Streamlit Code Structure)

Sidebar Navigation (Multi-page Design)

```
st.sidebar.title("Navigation")
page = st.sidebar.radio("Go to", ["Home", "Process Notes"])
```

Home Page Layout

```
st.title("✍️ Scribble to Digital")
st.write("Convert messy handwritten notes into structured digital content.")

col1, col2, col3 = st.columns(3)

with col1:
    st.info("📷 Upload Notes")

with col2:
    st.info("🧠 Smart Correction")

with col3:
    st.info("✅ To-Do Extraction")
```

Processing Page Layout

```
uploaded_file = st.file_uploader(
    "Upload handwritten notes image",
    type=["png", "jpg", "jpeg"]
)

if uploaded_file:
    st.image(uploaded_file)

if st.button("Convert to Digital ✨"):
    with st.spinner("Processing..."):
        # Call OCR + AI functions
        st.success("Processing Complete!")
```

Activity 4.4: Export Interface

Export Options:

- Download Clean Text (.txt)
- Download Task List (.csv)
- Future enhancement: PDF export

```
st.download_button("Download Text", clean_text)
```

Activity 4.5: UI Design Principles Applied

- Clean card-style sections
- Proper spacing
- Clear section separation
- User feedback (spinner, success message)
- Mobile responsive (Streamlit auto-adjusts)
- Logical workflow design

Complete User Interaction Flow

- User opens application.
- Views landing page with features.
- Navigates to processing page.
- Uploads handwritten image.
- Clicks convert.
- Views:
  - Clean text
  - Extracted tasks
- Downloads results.

MILESTONE 5: Testing & Optimization

Scribble to Digital – Handwritten Notes Digitizer

This milestone focuses on comprehensive testing, quality validation, and performance optimization of the Scribble to Digital application to ensure accuracy, reliability, and smooth user experience.

Activity 5.1: Comprehensive Testing

Test Scenarios

Test Scenario 1: Clear Handwriting

- High-resolution image
- Proper lighting
- Neatly written text

Expected Result:

- Accurate OCR text extraction
- Proper grammar correction using AI
- Correct identification of tasks

Outcome:

The system successfully extracted clean text and correctly separated action items into a to-do list.

Test Scenario 2: Medium Quality Handwriting

- Slight shadows
- Minor spelling distortions
- Mixed notes and tasks

Expected Result:

- OCR extracts readable text
- AI corrects spelling using contextual logic
- Tasks are properly separated

Outcome:

The AI improved sentence clarity and successfully identified most tasks.

Test Scenario 3: Poor Quality Image

- Blurry text
- Low brightness
- Irregular handwriting

Expected Result:

- Partial text extraction
- Context-based correction

- Limited but usable output

Outcome:

Image enhancement improved visibility, and the AI generated partially corrected readable text.

Test Scenario 4: Notes Without Tasks

- Informational notes only
- No action keywords

Expected Result:

- Clean digital text
- No tasks detected

Outcome:

System correctly displayed cleaned notes and returned “No tasks detected”.

Test Scenario 5: Bullet Point Notes

- Notes containing dashes or numbers
- Clearly defined tasks

Expected Result:

- Structured to-do list
- Proper formatting

Outcome:

Tasks were correctly identified and formatted as a digital list.

Activity 5.2: Quality Evaluation

The following aspects were evaluated:

- OCR Accuracy

  The percentage of correctly recognized words from handwritten input.
- Contextual Correction

  Improvement in grammar, clarity, and sentence meaning after AI processing.
- To-Do Extraction Accuracy

  Correct identification of action items without duplication or irrelevant content.
- Format Consistency

  Proper separation of clean text and to-do list sections.
- Export Quality

  Verification that downloaded files (TXT, CSV, PDF if enabled) are correctly formatted and usable.

Activity 5.3: Performance Optimization

Several improvements were implemented to enhance system performance:

- Optimized image preprocessing to reduce processing time.
- Improved prompt structure to reduce unnecessary API response length.
- Added input validation for file type and size.
- Implemented loading spinner to improve user experience.
- Prevented automatic reprocessing on page refresh in Streamlit.
- Handled API and OCR errors gracefully with user-friendly messages.

Stress Testing

Multiple images were uploaded sequentially to verify stability.

Large image files were tested to ensure the system does not crash.

System remained stable under continuous usage.

Edge Case Handling

- Blank image upload
- Non-text image upload
- OCR failure
- Gemini API failure
- Internet connectivity issues
- All cases were handled with appropriate error messages.

Conclusion

Scribble to Digital transforms traditional handwritten note-taking into an intelligent, AI-powered digital workflow. By combining OCR technology with advanced generative AI, the system accurately extracts handwritten content, enhances readability through contextual correction, and intelligently identifies actionable tasks. The integration of image preprocessing, structured AI prompts, and a responsive Streamlit frontend ensures a seamless and user-friendly experience.

From image enhancement and text recognition to contextual understanding and to-do extraction, every component of Scribble to Digital is designed with a focus on accuracy, efficiency, and reliability. The system not only digitizes messy notes but also adds value by organizing content into clean text and structured task lists, saving users time and effort.

With modular architecture, effective error handling, and optimized performance, Scribble to Digital demonstrates how AI can bridge the gap between handwritten creativity and digital productivity. Whether used by students, professionals, or teams, the application serves as a smart assistant that enhances organization, improves clarity, and streamlines everyday workflows.

1